

INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

WEEK # 1

Instructor: Ms. Fizza Haider

Sessional Work: Portfolio

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|---------------------------|----------|
| a) Mid-Term | 20 Marks |
| b) Assignment (Portfolio) | 10 Marks |
| c) Presentation | 10 Marks |

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Communication**
 - **Definition, Types** (nonverbal/oral/written/technological), **Levels** (intra/inter/small group/ organizational/ public/mass), **Nonverbal Communication** (temporal/environment/person-oriented)
 - **Feedback & its types** (positive-negative/immediate-delayed/low-high monitoring/critical-supportive/judgmental-non-judgmental)
Characteristics (7C's of Effective Communication),
Barriers/Problems (Noise/Distortion/Gender differences/language/lacking communication skills/problems in the message/information over/underload)
- **Oral Communication**
 - **Interviews:** Theory and preparation
 - **Presentations:** Theory

Course Contents

- **Business Writing**

- **Planning Audience Centered Business Messages:** Audience Analysis (psychographic & demographic profile), **Five Types of Audiences** (initial/ gatekeeper/ primary/ secondary/ watchdog)
- **Letter Elements and formats:** practice in writing letters)
- **Three types of Business Messages & organizational plans** (Direct/Indirect/Persuasive)
- **Practice in writing business messages** (letters/memo) for situations (Enquiries, responses, special announcements, granting and rejecting requests etc)
- **Employment communication:** job application and resume
- **Tenders, Inter Office Communication:** Memorandum, Meetings: notice, agenda, and minutes
- **Report Writing: Report Types** (letter –memo/analytical-informational/based on purpose), **report structure, practice in writing short formal report.**

Course Contents

- **Engineering / Business Ethics**
 - **Development of Engineering Ethics**, Key issues in Engineering Ethics
 - **Code of Ethics** and Conduct of different national and global bodies
 - **Development of Engineering ethics and impact, Criteria for classifying a professional.**
 - **Four moral theories** as the basic ethical framework (utilitarianism/duty/rights/virtue ethics)
 - **Ethical problem solving Techniques**(line drawing/flow charting/conflict problems)
 - **Key Ethical Concerns and concepts:** confidentiality, risk and safety, environment and computer ethics, whistleblowing, bribes and gifts, sexual harassment etc. (Course pack will be provided to students for reading)

OBJECTIVES

WEEK # 1

This lecture will help students:

- Develop an understanding of Business and Organizational Communication
- Realize and analyze the importance of effective communication in an organizational setting
- Understand the flow of communication in an organization
- Design the flow of communication for the given situation through class activity
- Understand the process of communication and functions of various components involved

Think-Pair-Share

- Think of five words that express what communication looks like? then draw what you think communication looks like.
- Share your five words and your drawing with the person sitting next to you and notice their responses. What patterns do you observe in the responses?
- Write a paragraph that addresses at least one observation.

Communication is a series of experience of

Hearing



listening

speaking



Seeing



Touch



What is communication?

- Natural phenomenon
- Genetically inbuilt in all forms of life like human beings, animals.
- An art to express one's feelings, ideas, and emotions effectively and fruitfully

CLASS ACTIVITY # 1

- 1. Come up with your own definition of communication.
- 2. How do you define the term business?

What is Communication?

- Communication may be defined as:
- *giving, receiving or exchanging information, opinions or ideas by writing, speech or visual means, so that the message communicated is completely understood by the recipient(s).*

What is Communication?

- It has been derived from a Latin word 'communis' which means common
- Aristotle introduced the systematic study of communication process.
- He identified three essential elements in a communication system; **the speaker, the speech and the audience**

What is communication?

‘ Communication is the flow of material, information, perception and understanding between various parts and members of an organization’

Conceptualizing Business Communication

- The business means any activity which is professional, formal, official, and career oriented, and work place related for which communication skills are needed to accomplish the activity. English language skills (all four viz. listening, speaking, reading, and writing) are a pre-requisite to undertake communication skills enhancement.

Areas/Levels of Communication

1. Intrapersonal Communication

Communication with oneself

To think, reason, analyze and reflect

It enhances self-esteem, increasing self awareness, improving problem solving, analyzing abilities, increasing self-control, reducing stress and managing interpersonal conflicts.

Areas/Levels of Communication

2. Interpersonal Communication

Communication between two persons

To discover, relate, influence, help

It helps in increasing effectiveness in one to one communication, developing and maintaining effective relationships, improving conflict resolution abilities.

Areas/Levels of Communication

3. Small Group Communication

Communication within a small group of persons

To share information, generate ideas, solve problems and help

It helps in increasing effectiveness as a group member, improving leadership abilities, using the groups to achieve specific purposes.

Areas/Levels of Communication

4. Organizational Communication

Communication within a formal organization

To increase productivity, raise morale, inform and persuade

It helps in improving efficiency of upward, downward and lateral communication, using communication to improve morale and increase productivity, reducing information overload, structuring networks to increase efficiency.

Areas/Levels of Communication

5. Public Communication

Communication of speaker to the audience

To inform, persuade, entertain

It helps in communicating information more effectively, increasing persuasive ability

Developing, organizing, styling, delivering messages with greater effectiveness

Areas/Levels of Communication

6. Mass Communication

Communication addressed to an extremely large audience, mediated by audio and video means

To entertain, persuade, inform

It helps in improving our ability to use the media to greater effectiveness, increasing ability to control the media, avoiding being taken in by advertisements and tabloid journalism.

Communication in Organizational Settings

	Internal	External
Formal	Planned communication among insiders (such as memos, reports, e-mail, instant messages, executive blogs, conference calls, and presentations) that follows the company's chain of command	Planned communication with outsiders (such as letters, reports, speeches, websites, instant messages, and news releases, advertising, and executive blogs)
Informal	Casual communication among employees (such as e-mail, instant messages, face-to-face conversations, phone calls, team blogs, and wikis) that do not follow the company's chain of command	Casual communication with suppliers, customers, investors, and other outsiders (such as face-to-face conversations, e-mail, instant messages, phone calls, and customer-support blogs)

DIRECTION OF COMMUNICATION

- Downward

Communication that flows from one level to a lower level

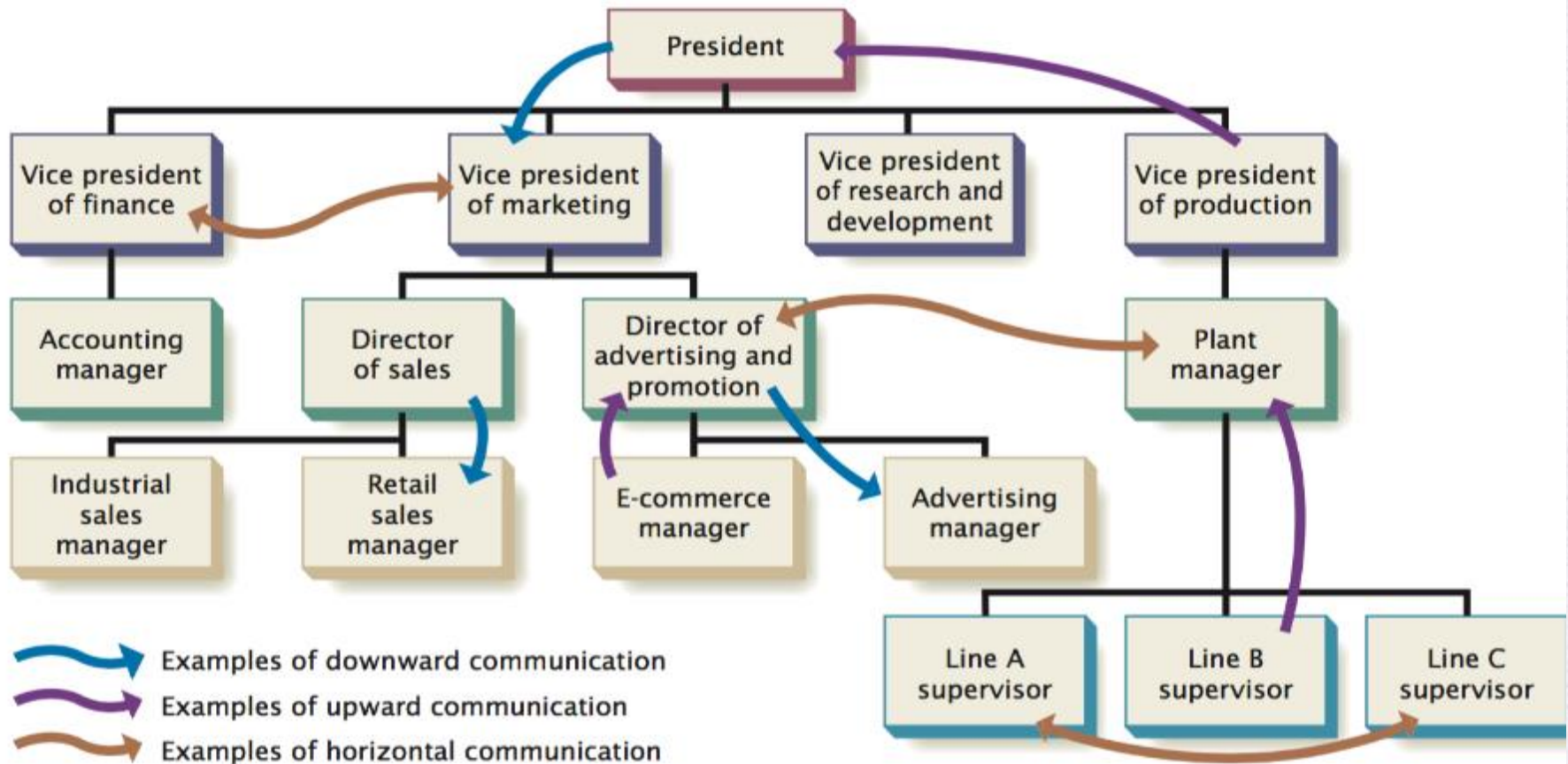
- Upward

Communication that flow to a higher level in an organization

- Lateral/Horizontal

Communication that takes place among members of the same level

FORMAL ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATION



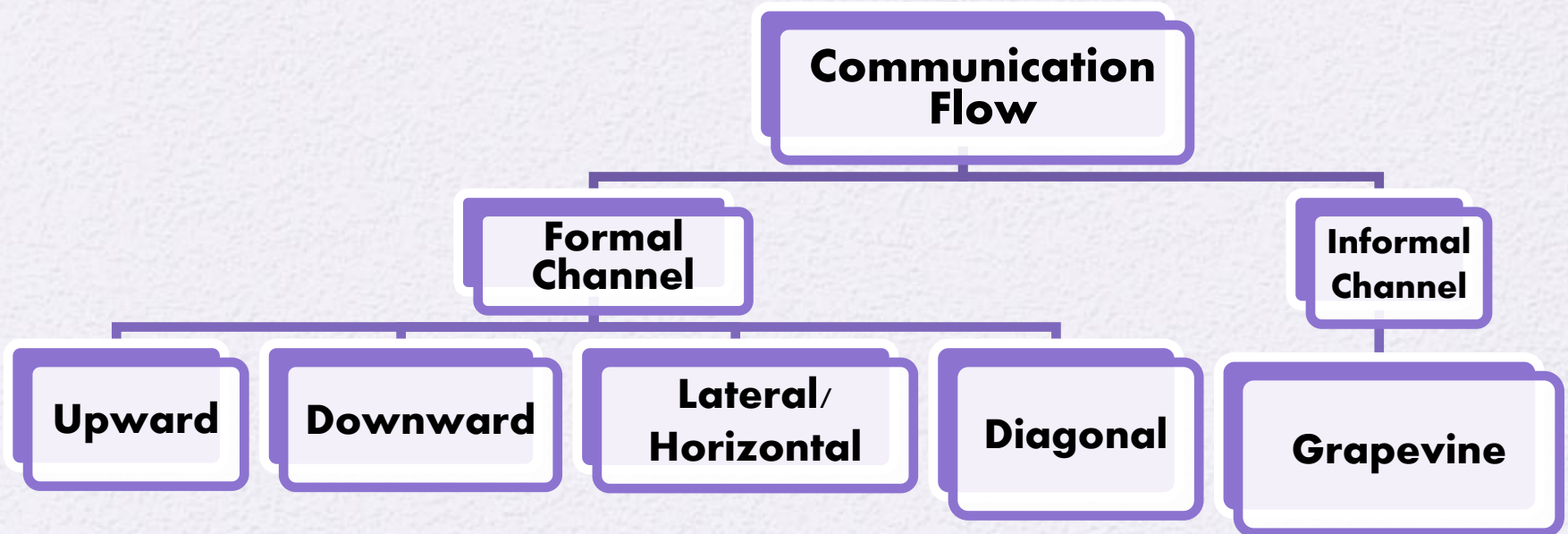
CLASS ACTIVITY # 2

- 2 Internal Communication: Planning the Flow** For the following tasks, identify the necessary direction of communication (downward, upward, horizontal), suggest an appropriate type or types of communication (casual conversation, formal interview, meeting, workshop, web conference, instant messaging, memo, blog, bulletin board notice, and so on), and briefly explain your suggestions.
- a. As human resources manager, you want to announce details about this year's company picnic.
 - b. As director of internal communication, you want to convince top management of the need for an internal executive blog.

CLASS ACTIVITY # 2

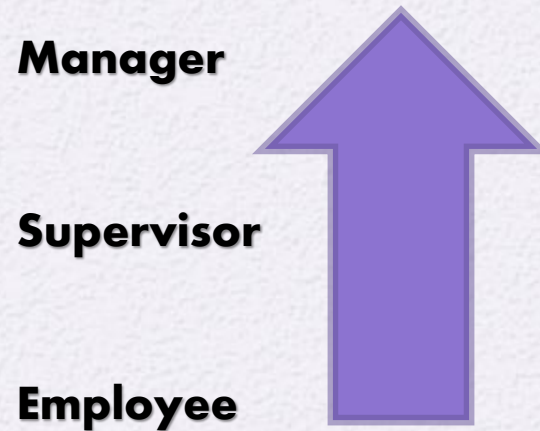
- c.** As production manager, you want to make sure that both the sales manager and the finance manager receive your scheduling estimates.
- d.** As marketing manager, you want to help employees throughout the company understand the marketplace and customer needs.

○ Modes/Flow of Communication



- **Upward Flow of Communication**

The transmission of information from lower levels of an organization to the higher ones.



Manager

- **Downward Flow of Communication**

The transmission of information from higher levels of an organization to the lower ones.

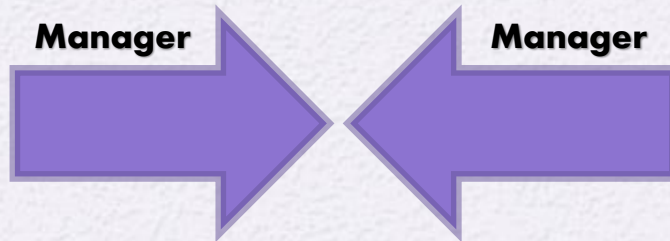
Superviso



Employee

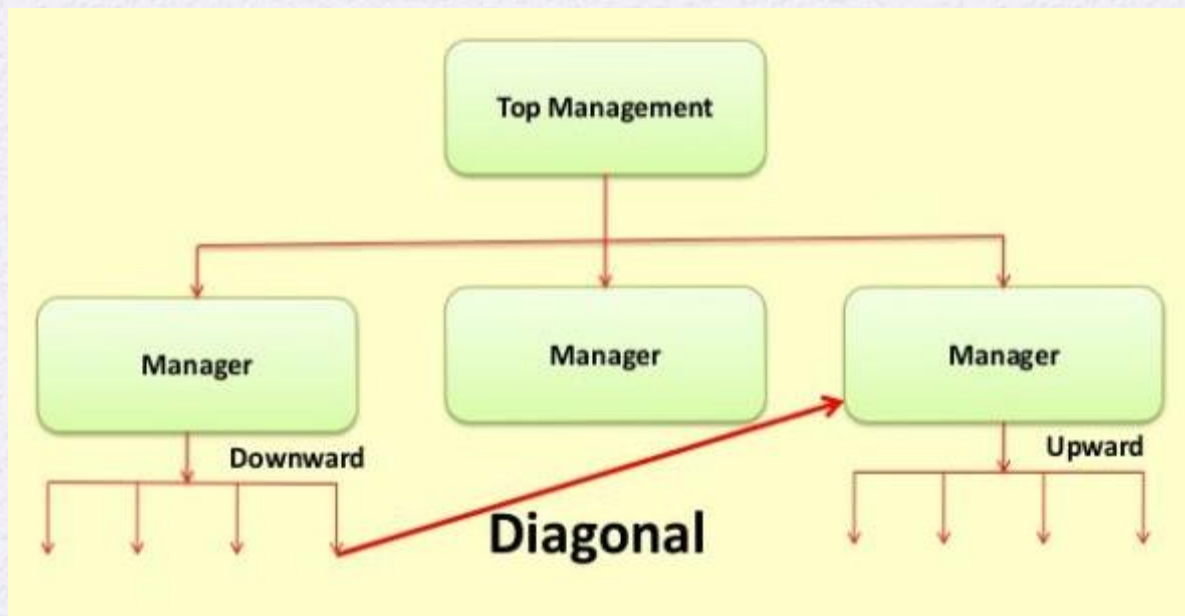
- **Horizontal Flow of Communication**

The flow of messages between individuals and groups on the same level of an organization, as opposed to up or down.

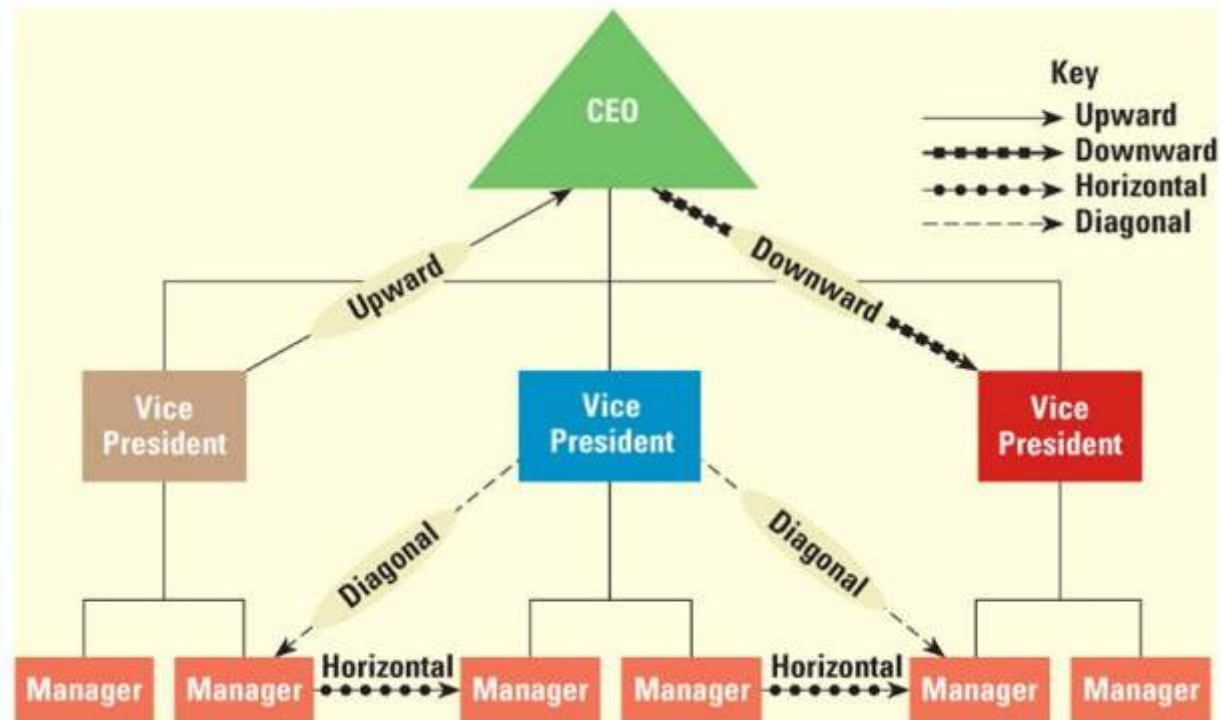
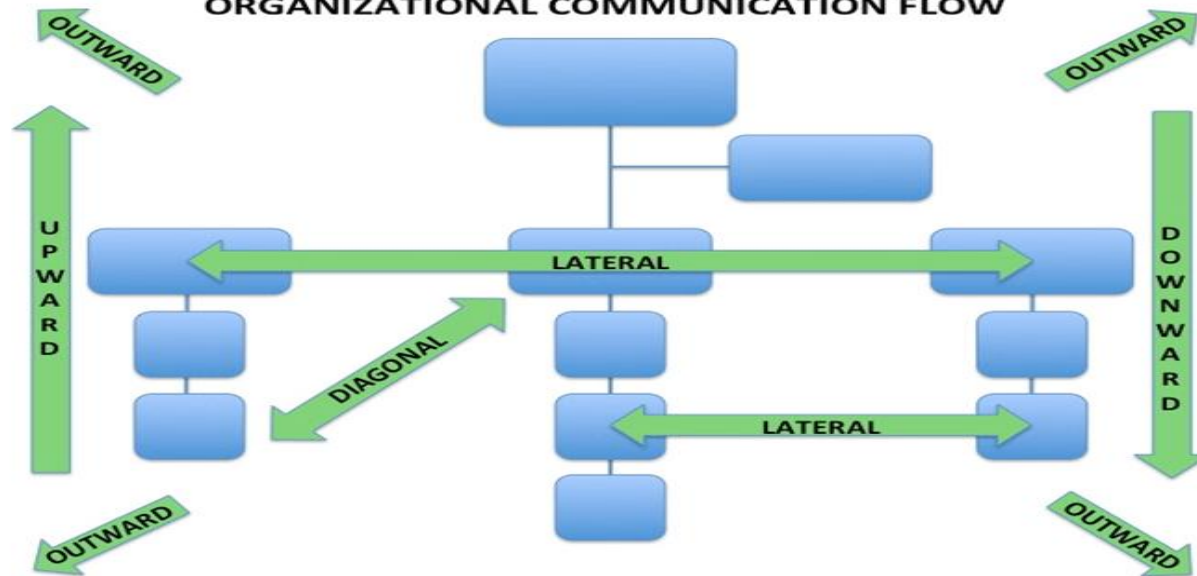


○ **Diagonal Flow of Communication**

The sharing of information among different structural levels within a business setting.



ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATION FLOW



Grapevine Communication

Grapevine communication is defined as unstructured and informal network formed on social relationship rather than organizational charts or job descriptions.



Watch this video:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XLEQw2dCsqQ&t=52s>

Functions of Communication

- Control
- Motivation
- Emotional expression
- Information

Communication Has Purpose

- When people communicate with each other, they have a purpose for doing so. The purpose may be serious or trivial, and they may or may not be aware of it at the time. Here we list five basic purposes for communication
- **1. We communicate to develop and maintain our sense of self.** Through our interactions, we learn who we are, what we are good at, and how people react to how we behave.

Communication Has Purpose

- **2. We communicate to meet our social needs.** Just as we need food, water, and shelter, so too do we need contact with other people. People may converse for hours.
- **3. We communicate to develop and maintain relationships.** Not only do we get to know others through our communication with them but, more importantly, we develop relationships with them—relationships that grow and deepen or stagnate and wither away.



- For example, when Beth calls Leah to ask whether she'd like to join her for lunch to discuss a project they are working on, her purpose actually may be to resolve a misunderstanding they've had because she wants to maintain a positive relationship with Leah.

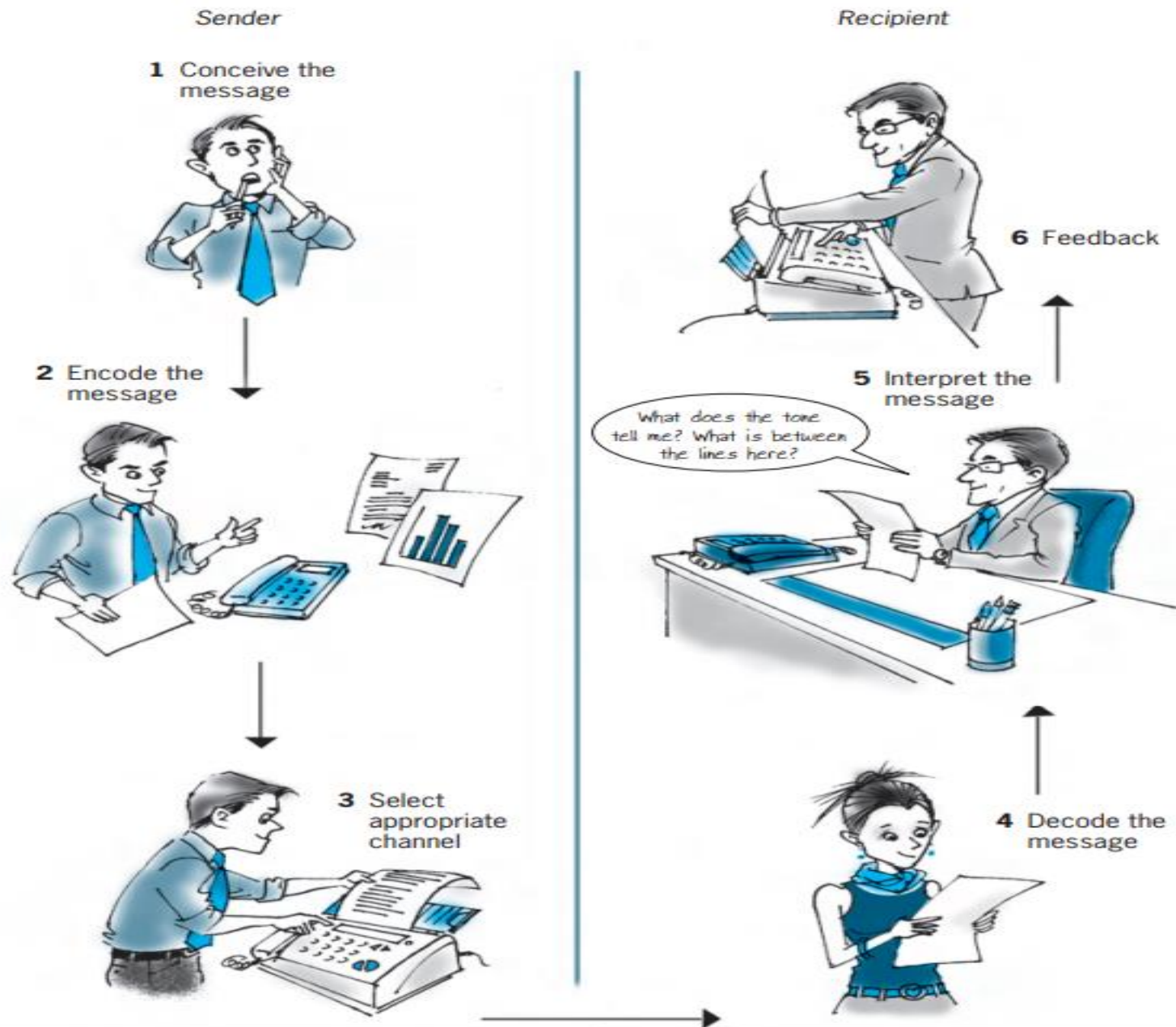
Communication Has Purpose

- **4. We communicate to exchange information.** Some information we get through observation, some through reading, some through media, and a great deal through direct communication with others, whether face-to-face, via text messaging, or online through e-mail and social networking sites



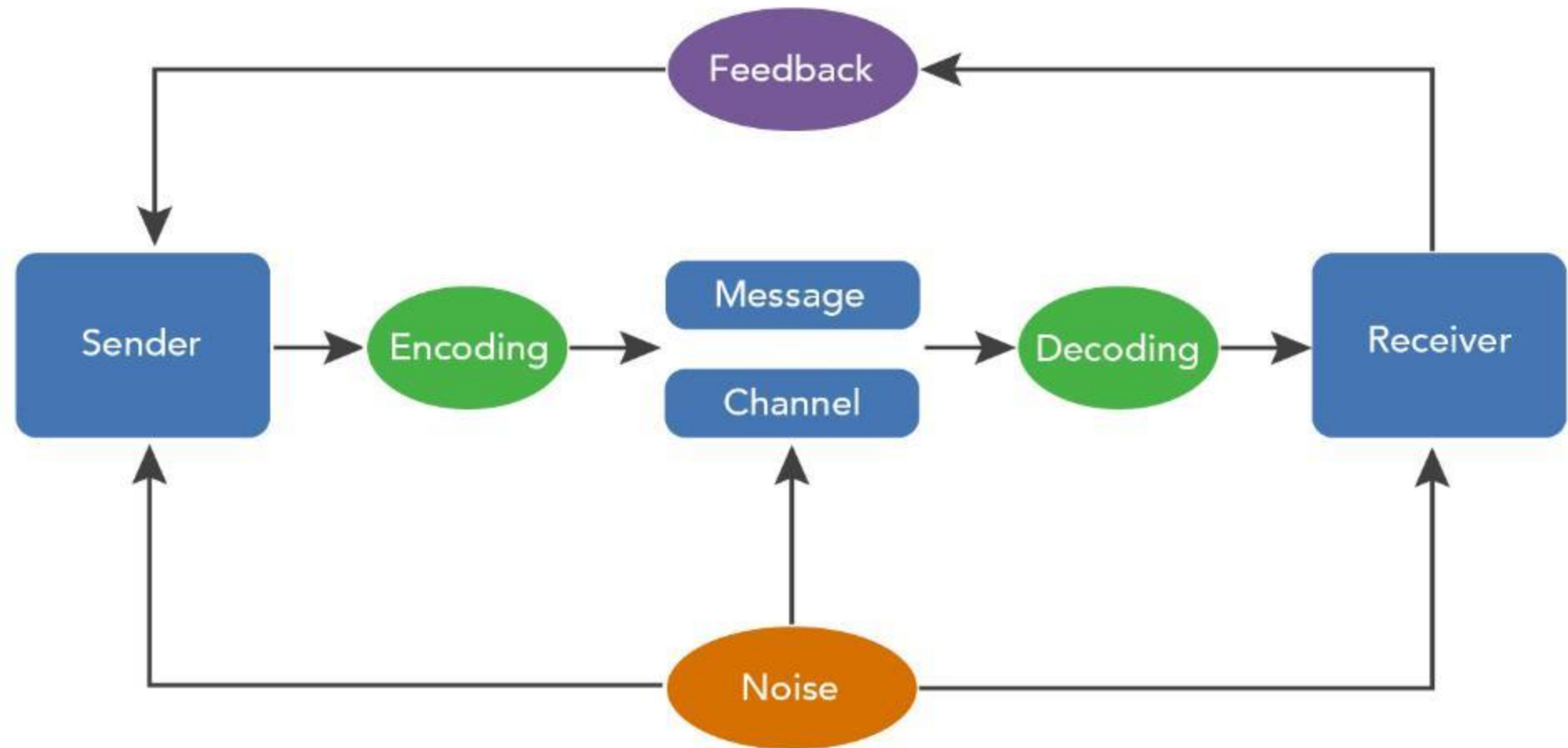
- Whether we are trying to decide how warmly to dress or whom to vote for in the next election, all of us have countless exchanges that involve sending and receiving information.
- **5. We communicate to influence others.** It is doubtful that a day goes by in which you don't engage in behavior such as to persuade your supervisor to alter your schedule.

KEY STAGES IN THE COMMUNICATION CYCLE

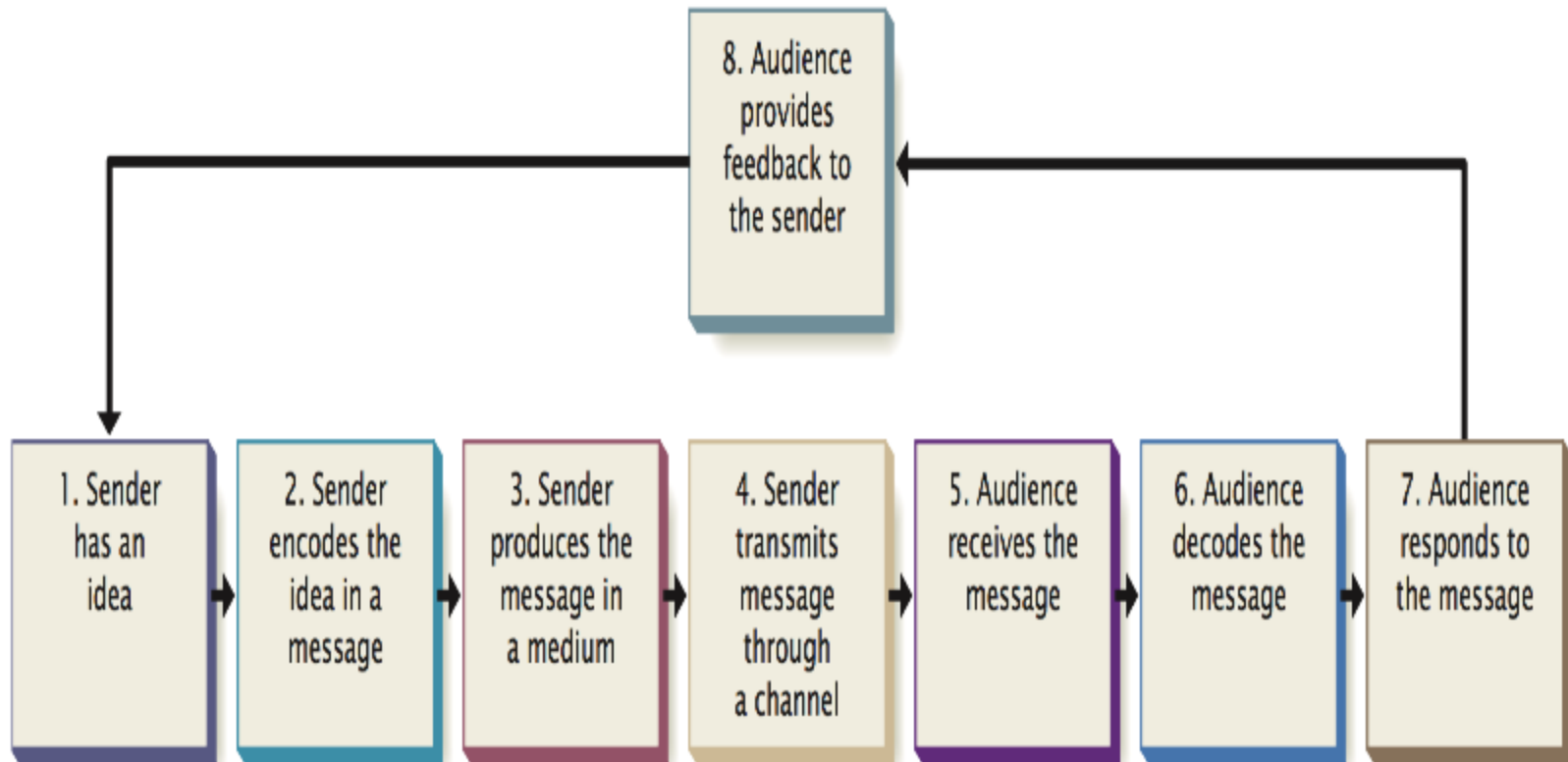


COMMUNICATION PROCESS

- It involves the following components



COMMUNICATION PROCESS



The Process of Communication

- Communication refers to the act, by one or more persons, of sending and receiving messages that are distorted by **noise**, occur within our context, have some effect, and provide some opportunity for feedback.
- The communication process takes place in a context (**physical, cultural, social-psychological, and temporal**) and is subjected to interference by noise (**physical, psychological, and semantic**). The interaction of messages with the encoder-decoder leads to some effect.

The Communication Context

All communication takes place in a context that has at least four dimensions:

a. The Physical Context: It is the tangible or concrete environment in which communication takes place. The physical context exerts some influence on the content (what to say) and the form (how you say) of your message.

b. The Cultural Context: it refers to the communicator's rules and norms, beliefs and attitude that are transmitted from one generation to the other.

c. The Social-Psychological Context: it includes the status relationships among partners, the roles that people play, and the cultural rule of the society in which they are communicating. It also includes the friendliness/ unfriendliness, formality/informality, and seriousness/ humorousness of a situation.

d. The Temporal (Time) Context: it includes the time of the day as well as the time in history in which communication takes place.

The Communication Context

- These **four dimensions** of context interact with each other.
- For example, arriving late for an appointment (**temporal context**) will be interpreted differently in different cultures (**cultural context**). Sometimes arriving late might lead to change in the social-psychological context; perhaps creating tension and unfriendliness, which in turn may lead to changes in physical context.
- The hyphenated term source-receiver emphasizes that each person involved in communication is both a source (speaker) and a receiver (listener). You send messages when you speak, write, gesture, or smile. You receive messages in listening, reading, feeling, and so on.

Steps of the Communication Process

1. Sender has an idea:

The process of communication begins when the person with whom the message originates—the *sender*—has an idea. The form of the idea will be influenced by complex factors surrounding the sender. The form of the idea, whether a simple greeting or a complex idea, is shaped by assumptions based on the sender's experiences.

Steps of the Communication Process

2. Sender encodes idea in message:

The next step in the communication process involves *encoding*. This means converting the idea into words or gestures that will convey meaning. In selecting proper symbols, senders must be alert to the receiver's communication skills, attitudes, background, experiences, and culture.

Steps of the Communication Process

3. Message travels over channel:

This stage is where the message is actually sent and the information is transferred. The technological revolution has brought about a wide range of telecommunication methods. Sender must consider all aspects: speed, cost, quick receipt, printed record, confidentiality, etc., and make an intelligent decision before sending the message. Time and money can be wasted if the wrong medium is chosen.

Steps of the Communication Process

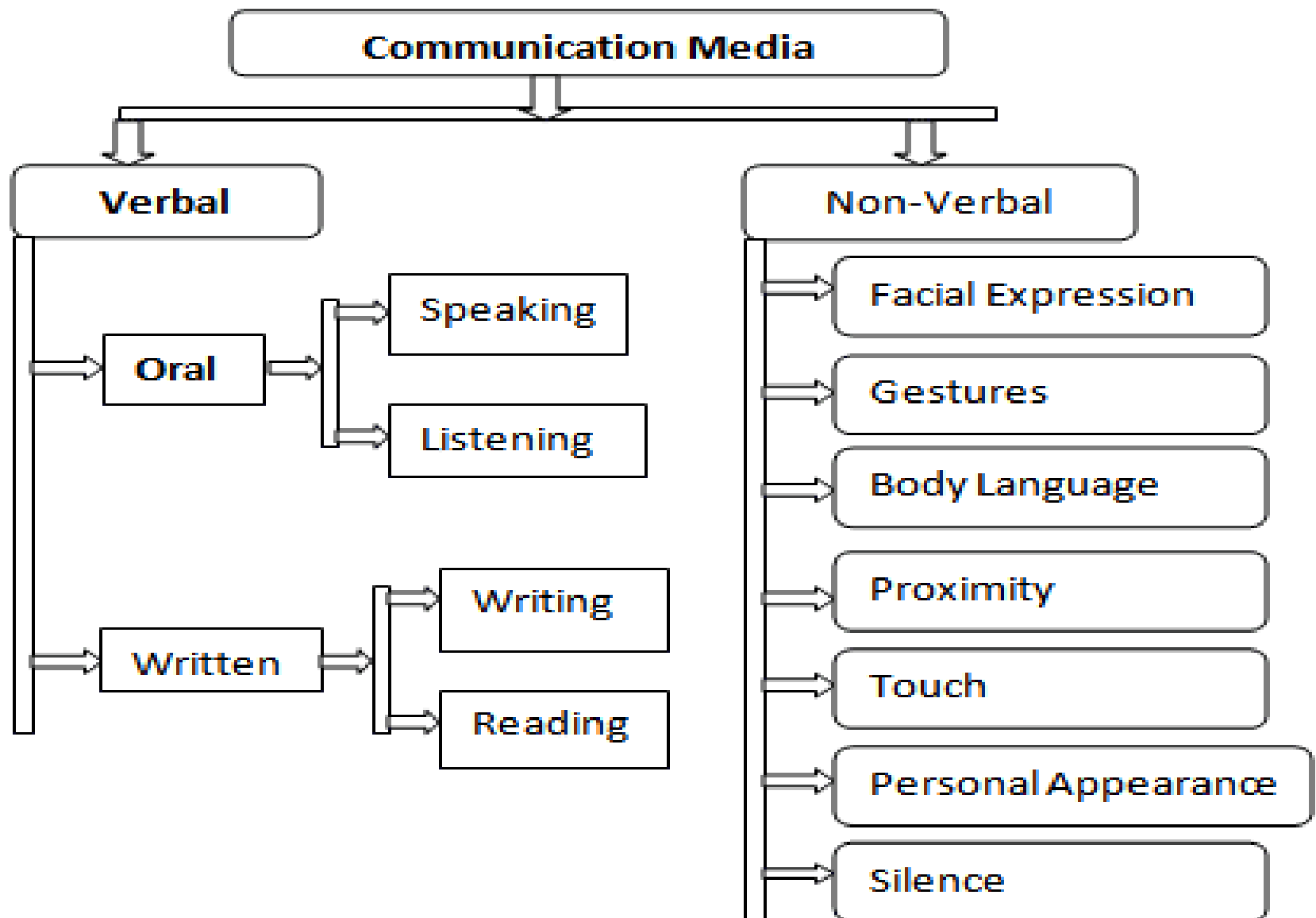
4. Receiver decodes message:

Only when the receiver understands the meaning intended by the sender—that is, successfully decodes the message—does communication take place. Such success, however, is difficult to achieve because no two people share the same life experiences and because many barriers can disrupt the process.

Steps of the Communication Process

5. Feedback travels to sender:

The verbal and nonverbal responses of the receiver create *feedback*, a vital part of the communication process. Feedback helps the sender know that the message was received and understood. The best feedback is descriptive rather than evaluative. An evaluative response is judgmental and doesn't tell the sender whether the receiver actually understood the message.



Types of Communication

1. Oral Communication

Oral communication involves using speech to exchange information with others. You usually communicate orally in face-to-face conversations. Meetings, interviews, conferences, speeches, and phone calls are other forms of verbal communication. In business, you communicate verbally to exchange ideas, understand diverse points of view, and solve problems. Oral communication is an efficient way to develop consensus when many people must be consulted. Because verbal skills are among those most valued by employers, developing these skills will help you find jobs, advance your career, and improve your professional performance.

Types of Communication

2. Written Communication

All different forms of written communication can be formal or informal. If today, we visit a court of law, you will find that even WhatsApp messages are considered to be legal in nature. In fact, there have been so many cases of celebrities brought under the scanner because of wrong written communications on their social media account.

Thus, the above example is further proof that written communication needs to be used safely and effectively. In fact, written communication between friends can be informal but this type of communication between working professionals should always be formal so that any misquoted words are not misused with ill intent.

Types of Communication

3. Technological Communication

New electronic technologies are dramatically affecting the way workers communicate. We now exchange information and stay in touch by using e-mail, instant messaging, text messaging, PDAs, fax, voice mail, wireless networking, cell phones, powerful laptop computers, and satellite communications. Through teleconferencing and videoconferencing, we can conduct meetings with associates around the world.

There are many many ways that written communications can be used. The number of ways is ever increasing with the penetration of smartphones and the internet. One of the most common forms of written communications used till date is Email. But slowly, written type of communications is becoming more informal with Whatsapp and other online messaging apps being used regularly.

Types of Communication

4. Non-verbal Communication

Nonverbal communication is expressed through nonlinguistic means. It is the actions or attributes of humans, including their appearance, use of objects, sound, time, smell, and space, that have socially shared significance and stimulate meaning in others. It includes visual/kinesthetic cues such as facial expressions, eye movements, gestures, and body orientation; vocal/paralinguistic cues such as volume, pitch, rate, and inflection; proxemic cues such as space and distance; olfactory or smell cues; cues provided via appearance; cues sent via color; and time.

Our interpersonal effectiveness depends on more than words. Nonverbal messages add to or detract from our words. In effect, we become the message, with our nonverbal cues announcing our state of mind, expectations, and sense of self. Our entire beings chatter incessantly, revealing what we really feel and think.

CLASS ACTIVITY # 3

11 **Communication Process: Analyzing Miscommunication**

Use the eight phases of the communication process to analyze a miscommunication you've recently had with a co-worker, supervisor, classmate, teacher, friend, or family member. What idea were you trying to share? How did you encode and transmit it? Did the receiver get the message? Did the receiver correctly decode the message? How do you know? Based on your analysis, identify and explain the barriers that prevented your successful communication in this instance.

How Audiences Receive Messages

For an audience to receive a message, three events need to occur

1. The receiver has to **sense** the presence of a message
2. **Select** it from all the other messages
3. Then **perceive** it as an actual message (as opposed to random, pointless noise)

How Audiences Decode Messages

Decoding a message to assign meaning to it is a complicated and often highly personal process

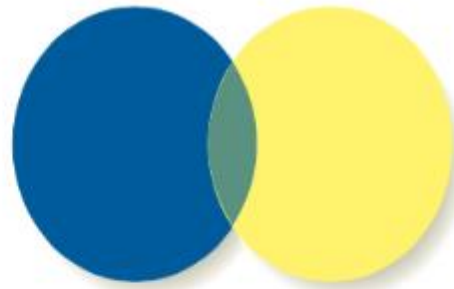
1. It is affected by culture, individual experience, learning and thinking styles, hopes, fears and even temporary moods.
2. Audiences tend to extract the meaning they expect to get from a message, not the meaning that you intended
3. Sometimes, audiences recreate their own meaning.

How Audiences Respond to Messages

Three events need to occur for audiences to respond to a message

1. Recipients have to **remember** the message long enough to act on it.
2. Recipients have to be **able** to respond according to your plan
3. Recipients have to be **motivated** to respond
4. By explaining how audiences will benefit by responding to your messages, you will increase their motivation to respond.

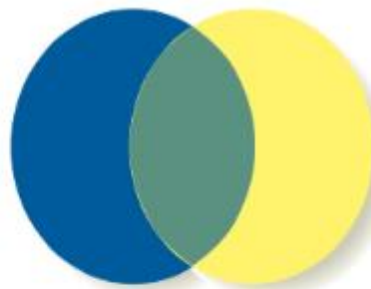
How Shared Experience Affects Understanding



Little shared
experience

Meanings
dissimilar

Misunderstanding



Average amount of
shared experience

Meanings
similar

Average degree of
understanding



Large amount of
shared experience

Meanings
very similar

High degree of
understanding

How to Get Noticed?

Craft your message using the following principles to increase your chances of success

1. Consider audience expectations

2. Ensure ease of use

3. Emphasize familiarity

4. Practice empathy

5. Design for compatibility

Weekly Task

1. Collect at least three definitions of Business Communication and write one-paragraph interpretation analyzing them all.
2. List five ways in which business communication differs from social communication.